



## **Subject Vision and Intent: PE**

### **Our Vision**

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that Physical Education is essential in helping children develop healthy, active lives, physical confidence and a positive sense of wellbeing. Our ambition is for every child to leave KCA with the competence and confidence to participate in physical activity and, most importantly, to have discovered ways of being active that they enjoy and can continue throughout their lives.

We want children to understand that being physically active is about much more than competitive sport. Through a broad range of experiences, children develop their physical literacy, discover their individual strengths and interests, and experience the enjoyment that can come from movement, participation and personal improvement.

Our PE curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Physical activity provides powerful opportunities for children to collaborate, communicate and celebrate one another's achievements. Through PE and sport, children also develop our KCA values: the courage to try something new, the respect and kindness required to participate alongside others, the integrity to compete fairly, the endurance to keep improving and the aspiration to achieve their personal best.

### **Our Intent**

Our PE curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary, physical skills and understanding we want children to develop from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to become increasingly competent, confident and independent participants in physical activity.

Children experience a broad range of physical activities, including athletics, gymnastics, dance, invasion games, net and wall games, outdoor and adventurous activities, and swimming. Through these experiences, children develop fundamental movement skills before applying and combining them with increasing control, fluency and precision.

Knowledge and physical skills are deliberately built over time. Children learn how to move effectively, apply tactics and strategies, work individually and collaboratively, and evaluate their own and others' performance. As they progress through the school, they are

increasingly expected to make decisions, solve problems and apply previously learned skills within more complex activities and situations.

We want children to understand their bodies and recognise the relationship between physical activity, health and wellbeing. They learn why regular physical activity matters, how exercise affects their bodies and how they can make choices that contribute to healthy, active lives.

PE also provides opportunities for significant personal development. Children learn to cooperate and communicate, lead and be led, compete appropriately, respond to success and disappointment, and persevere when something is difficult. We explicitly teach children that success in PE looks different for different people and that individual progress, participation and personal improvement are achievements worth celebrating.

## **Swimming**

Swimming is a distinctive and important part of our PE curriculum. Every year group from Reception to Year 6 participates in intensive swimming sessions, allowing children to develop water confidence, swimming technique and water safety progressively throughout their time at KCA.

This sustained approach provides children with repeated opportunities to develop their skills rather than relying upon a single period of swimming tuition. By the end of Key Stage 2, our ambition is for every child to be a safe and confident swimmer who can swim competently, confidently and proficiently over a distance of at least 25 metres and has developed the essential knowledge and skills required to stay safe around water.

## **Every Child**

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious PE curriculum and wider opportunities for physical activity and sport.

Teachers adapt activities, equipment, instruction and levels of support so that barriers to participation are reduced without lowering expectations. Explicit modelling, carefully sequenced practice, appropriate equipment and opportunities to repeat and refine movements enable children to experience success and develop increasing physical confidence.

Where children require additional support, provision such as sensory circuits, play-based movement sessions and targeted physical activities provides further opportunities to develop movement, regulation and confidence.

We recognise that children's access to sport, swimming and organised physical activity beyond school can vary considerably. Our curriculum and wider offer therefore ensure that every child has opportunities to encounter a broad range of activities, develop physical competence and discover forms of movement and sport that they enjoy.

## **PE Beyond the Curriculum**

Our commitment to physical activity extends beyond PE lessons. We provide children with opportunities to participate, represent their school, experience competition and enjoy being active alongside others.

As members of the Camden Schools Sports Association (CSSA), pupils in Years 3–6 have opportunities to represent KCA and participate in sporting events and competitions with other schools across Camden. These experiences allow children to apply what they have learned in PE while developing confidence, teamwork, resilience and sportsmanship.

Alongside competitive sport, children participate in inclusive competitions, festivals and other physical activities. We believe that representing KCA and experiencing the enjoyment of a sporting event should not be reserved only for the children who are already the most accomplished athletes. We deliberately seek opportunities for children with different strengths, experiences and levels of confidence to participate and succeed.

These experiences help children develop a sense of belonging and pride in representing their school while learning how to respond appropriately to both success and disappointment.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is not simply that children can perform a collection of physical skills. We want them to move with confidence and competence, understand how to participate safely and effectively, work successfully with others and recognise why physical activity matters for their health and wellbeing.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA as confident and enthusiastic participants in physical activity, equipped with the skills, knowledge and positive experiences that will help them choose to remain active throughout their lives.